RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

21 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 8:57 AM, Wednesday 21 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 151 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 44 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,651 minutes at 9:00 AM (no movements since HZA8 at 4:33 AM); Dammam moving again, its 3:58 to 6:01 AM halt ended

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,651 minutes at 9:00 AM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- No Riyadh takeoffs or landings since the 6:00 AM edition; last movement non-airline HZA8 to Heraklion at 4:33 AM, last landing Saudia SV979 at 7:51 PM Tuesday.
- 151 Wednesday Riyadh flights already cancelled (24%).
- Coalition intercepted 5 drones fired at Saudi Arabia from 6:52 AM over the Madinah and Eastern regions; no damage or casualties reported.
- Dammam airport moving again after a 3:58 to 6:01 AM halt; 10 takeoffs and 3 landings since 6:00 AM, latest flyadeal F31657 to Peshawar at 8:37 AM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13648 min).

151	0/0	5
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

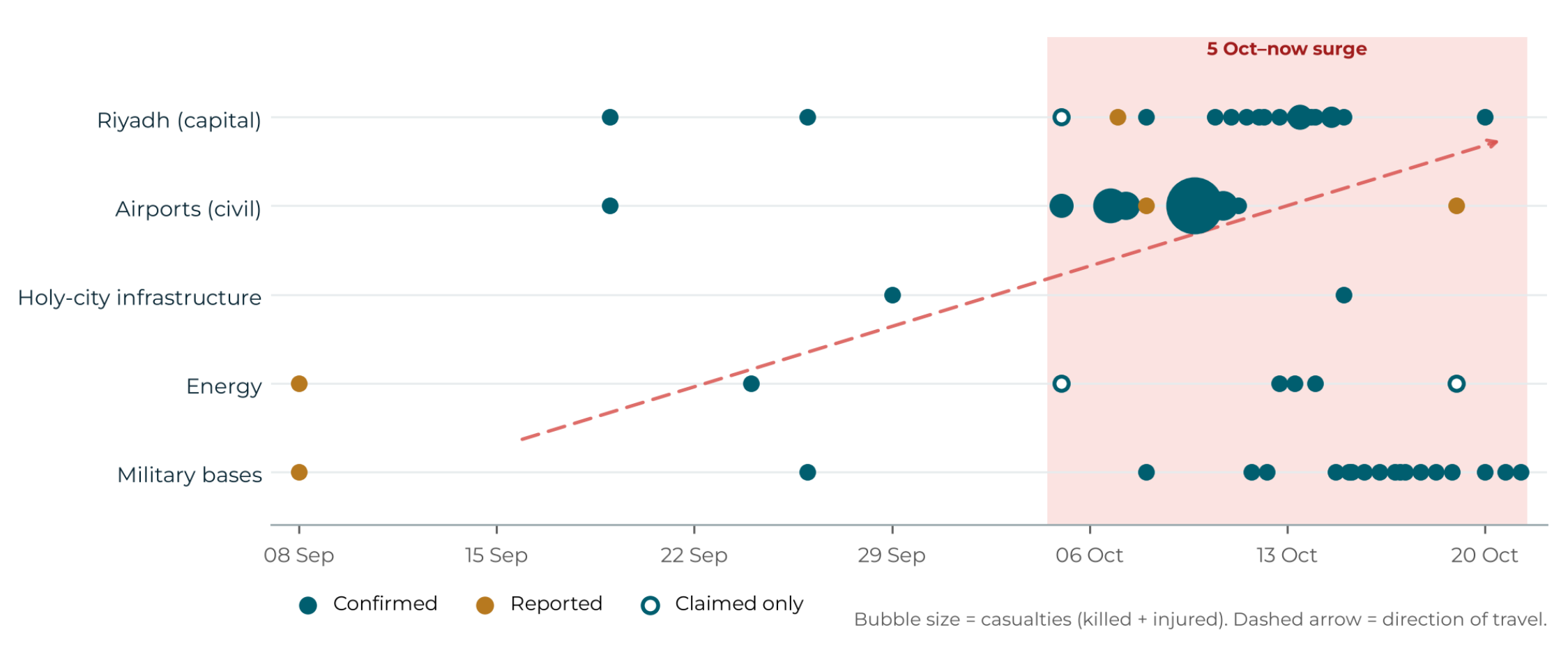
3 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

44	3/1	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (13,651 min at 9:00 AM); no takeoffs or landings since the 6:00 AM edition
- Coalition intercepted 4 drones over the Madinah and Eastern regions (6:52 AM) and another toward the Eastern Region (6:58 AM)
- Dammam's overnight halt (3:58 to 6:01 AM) ended; 10 takeoffs and 3 landings since 6:00 AM
- Riyadh airport again tells travellers to follow official authorities and their airline (7:47 AM)

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 21 OCT



56 sourced events since 8 September (48 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: a drone launched toward the Eastern Region intercepted and destroyed; target not stated, no damage or casualties reported (21 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

2

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 6:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **6:52 AM AST · Eastern Region**

Four drones launched toward Saudi Arabia intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah and Eastern regions; target not stated, no damage or casualties reported. Coalition spokesman / SPA · none reported

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **6:58 AM AST · Eastern Region**

A drone launched toward the Eastern Region intercepted and destroyed; target not stated, no damage or casualties reported. Coalition spokesman / SPA · none reported

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 5, alerts 1, all-clears 1.

3

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Coalition intercepts 5 drones over the Madinah and Eastern regions; Riyadh still halted; Dammam moving again

Checked at 8:56 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: another drone launched toward the Eastern Region intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · 6:58 AM · published 6:58 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Arabic, translated); SPA English 7:18 AM; checked 8:56 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Malki said a further drone launched toward the Eastern Region was intercepted and destroyed, minutes after the four-drone announcement. No damage or casualties were reported.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: four drones launched toward Saudi Arabia intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah and Eastern regions**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · 6:52 AM · published 6:52 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Arabic, translated); SPA English 7:18 and 7:28 AM, also Al Ekhbariya, Arab News; checked 8:56 AM

The coalition said four drones launched toward the Kingdom were intercepted and destroyed, and that the interceptions took place in the Madinah and Eastern regions. It did not say who launched them or report any damage or casualties.

CONFIRMED **Aden: growing numbers of people displaced fleeing Houthi fire**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 5:23 AM · published 5:23 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 5:58 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported a rising number of people arriving in Aden after fleeing fire from the Houthi militia. No figures were given in the post.

CONFIRMED **Saudi ambassador to Yemen: the Kingdom will protect its people, security and territory; Taiz will not be held hostage**

Saudi Ambassador Mohammed Al Jaber via SABA (Yemeni state news agency) · 4:20 AM · posted 4:20 AM AST Wed 21 Oct via the Yemeni Embassy in Pakistan's account quoting SABA; checked 5:58 AM

Saudi Ambassador to Yemen Mohammed Al Jaber said the Houthi militia trades on Yemenis' suffering, that Yemen does not belong to it and that Taiz will not be held hostage to its project, adding that the Kingdom will protect its people, security and territory.

CONFIRMED **UN calls for aid access to besieged Taiz; Yemen's endowments ministry calls the Houthi siege a crime**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 3:39 AM · published 3:39 AM and 4:17 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 5:58 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that the United Nations is calling for humanitarian aid to be allowed into Taiz province, which is besieged by the Houthis. Yemen's Ministry of Endowments told the channel the siege is a crime with no religious, customary or legal basis, and thanked Saudi Arabia for facilities given to Yemeni pilgrims.

UNVERIFIED **Unconfirmed reports of Houthi-Saudi border clashes near Jazan**

X account @MEBriefNews · 3:51 AM · posted 3:51 AM AST Wed 21 Oct; described by the poster as preliminary, no Saudi or coalition confirmation and no independent outlet reporting a crossing; checked 5:58 AM

An X news account reported preliminary claims of clashes between Houthi supporters and Saudi forces along the border, raising the possibility of a crossing into Jazan. No authority has confirmed it; the only verified material is Houthi video of drone strikes on Saudi border positions in Jizan and Asir released Tuesday evening.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces say about 200 Houthi fighters neutralised and 90 vehicles destroyed or disabled**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 2:45 AM · published 2:45 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); figures are the Yemeni forces' own, not independently verified; checked 2:56 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya, citing Yemen's government armed forces, reported that about 200 Houthi fighters were neutralised and 90 vehicles and pieces of military equipment destroyed or disabled. No location or time frame was given in the post.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Cabinet: regional stability and freedom of navigation are an international responsibility**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 12:59 AM · published 12:59 AM AST Wed 21 Oct in Al Ekhbariya's Tuesday roundup (translated from Arabic); checked 2:56 AM

Al Ekhbariya's roundup of Tuesday's news led with the Cabinet saying that strengthening regional stability and keeping navigation secure is an international responsibility, alongside the destruction of the launcher behind Tuesday's Riyadh missile.

CORROBORATED **UK to fly RAF Typhoon defensive air patrols over Saudi Arabia**

UK Ministry of Defence (GOV.UK); BBC, AP, Al Jazeera · 1:59 PM · MoD update published 1:59 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; still widely reported overnight; checked 2:56 AM

Britain says RAF Typhoons will fly defensive counter-air missions to protect Saudi cities and infrastructure from Houthi missiles and drones, without striking Houthi targets. It is also sending an A400M transport aircraft and advisers and extending air-to-air refuelling by 90 days.

UNVERIFIED **Footage circulating of travellers panicking at Riyadh airport after an explosion sound**

X account @Xnews_l · 11:22 PM · posted 11:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; date and location of the video not verified, no official report of a new incident at the airport; checked 11:58 PM

An X account posted video it says shows panic among travellers at King Khalid International Airport after the sound of an explosion. The date of the footage is not confirmed and no Saudi authority has reported a new incident tonight.

CONFIRMED **Coalition releases footage of tracking and striking the launcher behind Tuesday's ballistic missile at Riyadh**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · 10:25 PM · published 10:25 PM AST (Arabic), SPA English 10:47 PM; also Al Ekhbariya 10:29 PM; checked 11:58 PM

The coalition published video it says shows its forces tracking and destroying the Houthi launch platform used for the ballistic missile fired at Riyadh on Tuesday, following its 8:06 PM statement.

4

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13648 min).

151	4:33 AM	7:51 PM	0	5
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
71 departures + 80 arrivals, 24% of 634 scheduled.	HZA8 to Heraklion (non-airline flight), 263 min before 8:57 AM. Last airline: SV982, 3:02 AM.	SV979 from Guangzhou, 786 min before 8:57 AM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:57 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 145 at 8:57 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	71	80	151	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	68 (21%)	77 (25%)	145	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	1 (0%)	1 (0%)	2	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	3 (75%)	1 (50%)	4	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	72 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	3 of 90	0 of 80	3 of 170	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	5	5	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	34	33	67	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	175	180	355	FR24 stats panel

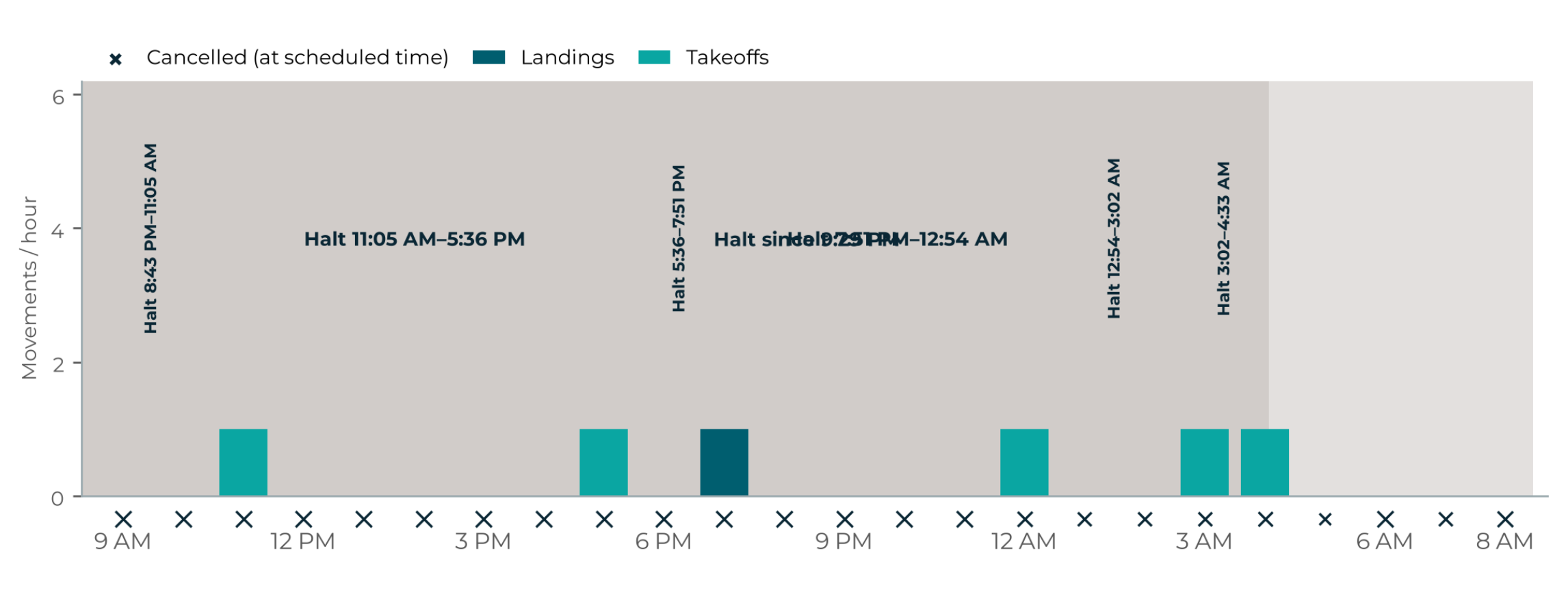
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	83
Gulf Air	10
flynas	7
flyadeal	7
Emirates	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Madinah	18
Jeddah	17
Dubai	14
Bahrain	12
Cairo	9

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



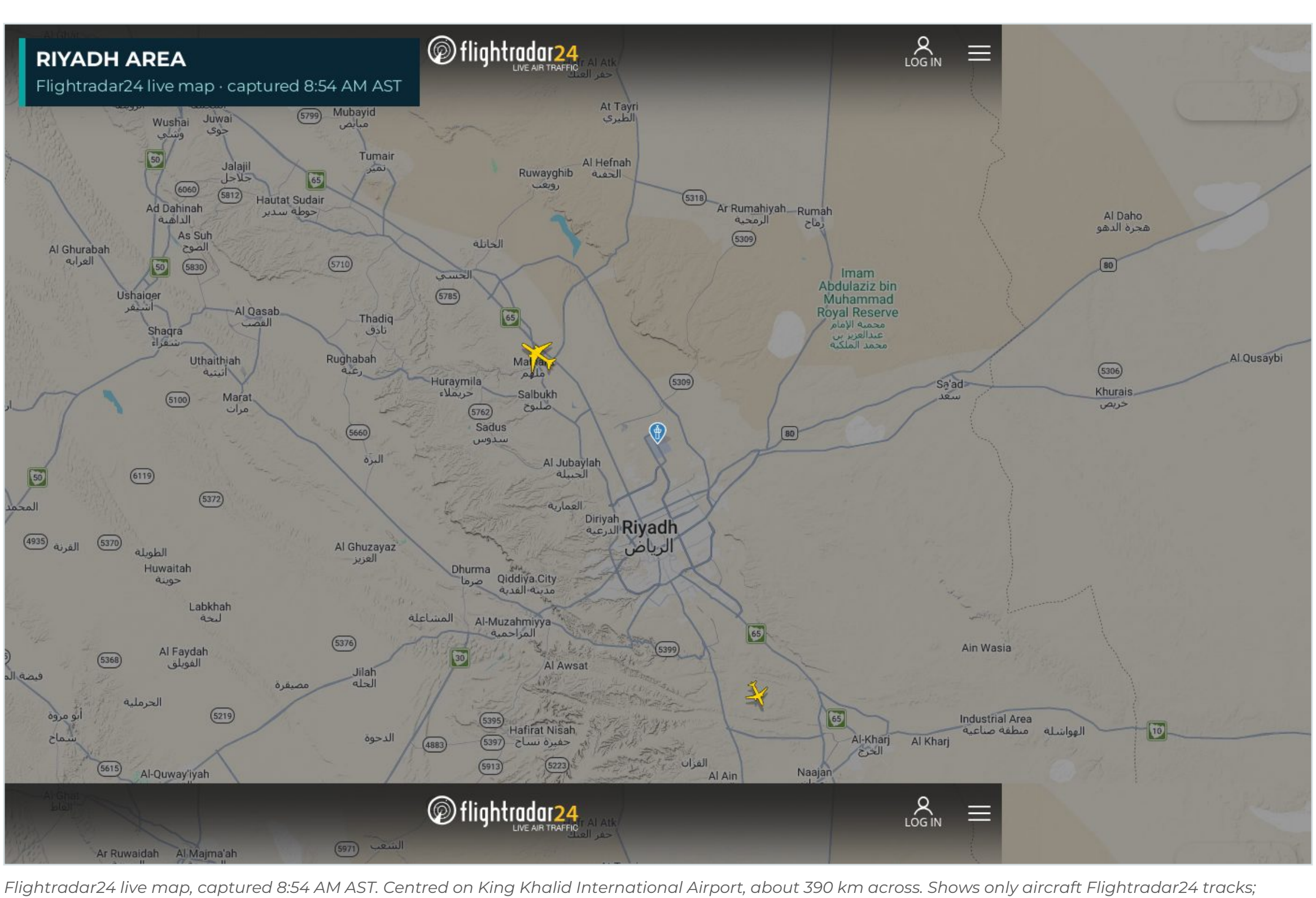
Recorded takeoffs (5) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 9:00 AM Tuesday to 8:57 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are delayed or non-scheduled flights: takeoffs HZSK5 to Geneva 11:05 AM and 0S2828 to Milan 5:36 PM Tuesday, Saudia SV992 12:54 AM, Saudia SV982 3:02 AM and HZA8 4:33 AM Wednesday, and the landing Saudia SV979 at 7:51 PM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 7:43–8:37 PM Tuesday, 1:45–2:55 AM, and 3:58–6:01 AM Wednesday (ended when Air Arabia G9161 took off).

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 3:02–4:33 AM	91 min
Halt 12:54–3:02 AM	128 min
Halt 7:51 PM–12:54 AM	303 min
Halt 5:36–7:51 PM	135 min
Halt 11:05 AM–5:36 PM	391 min

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



RIYADH AREA
Flightradar24 live map · captured 8:54 AM AST
flightradar24
LOG IN
Riyadh
Imam Abdulaziz bin Muhammad Royal Reserve
Al Kharj

Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:54 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

5

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 3 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

44	8:37 AM	8:02 AM	3	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
21 departures + 23 arrivals, 19% of 227 scheduled.	F31657 to Peshawar, 20 min before 8:57 AM.	XY402 from Jeddah, 55 min before 8:57 AM.	1 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:57 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 44 at 8:57 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	21	23	44	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	21 (18%)	23 (21%)	44	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	6 (5%)	2 (2%)	8	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	11 (65%)	7 (78%)	18	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	13 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	18 of 30	9 of 26	27 of 56	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	6	7	13	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	32	32	64	FR24 stats panel

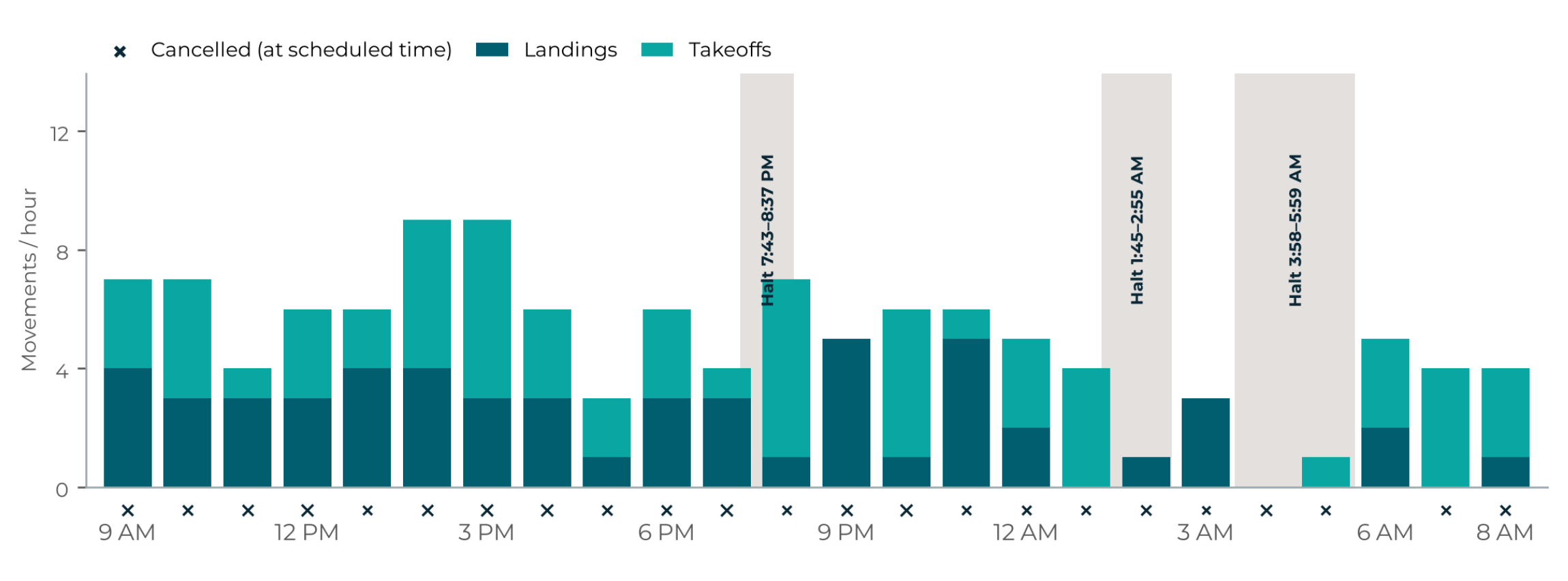
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Egyptair	8
Etihad Airways	8
flydubai	8
Saudia	7
Emirates	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Dubai	14
Abu Dhabi	8
Riyadh	7
Cairo	6
Madinah	3

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (63) and landings (55) at DMM per hour from 9:00 AM Tuesday to 8:57 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving: 10 takeoffs and 3 landings since 6:00 AM, 3 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour; overnight halt 3:58 to 6:01 AM ended.

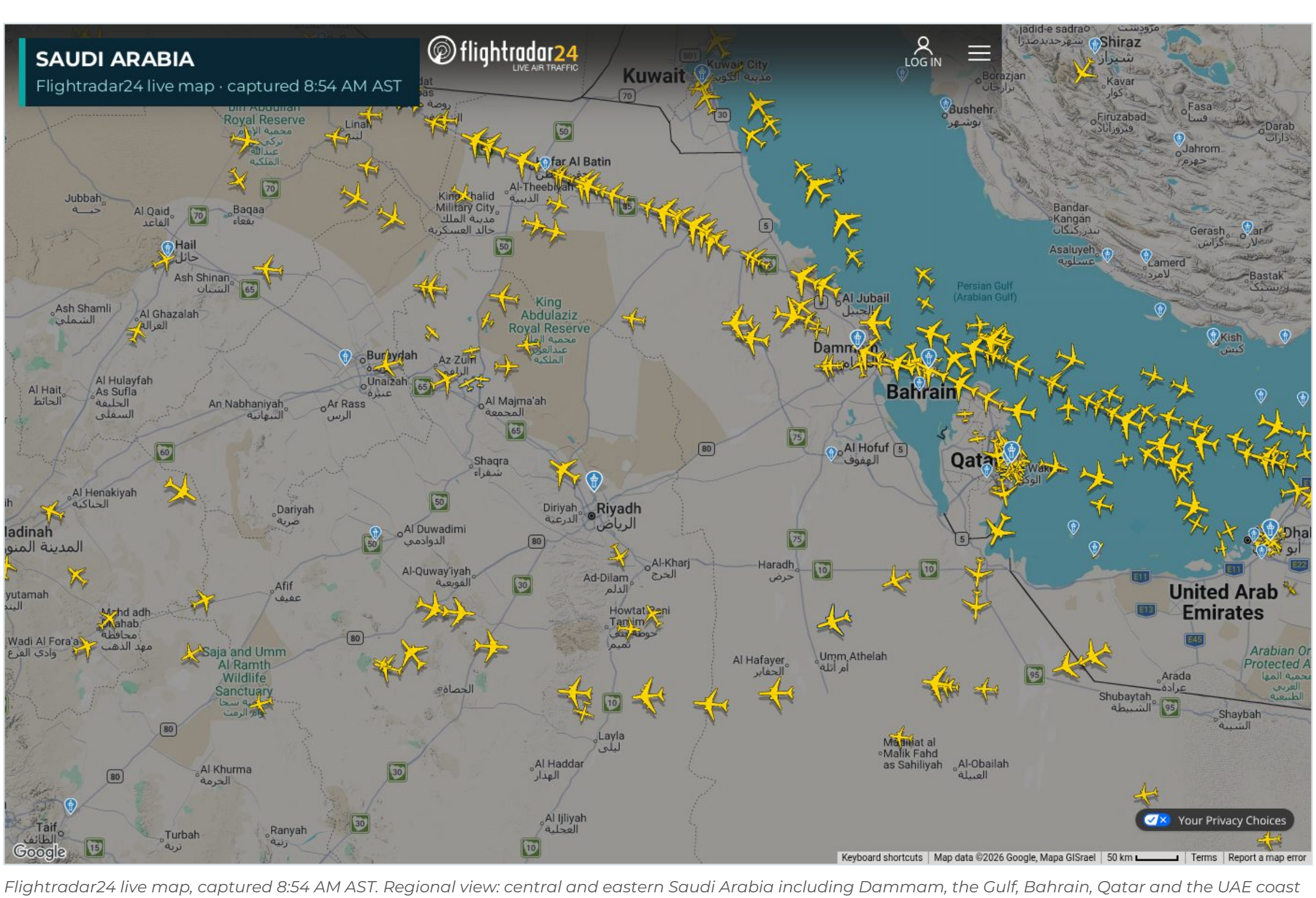
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 3:58–5:59 AM	120 min
Halt 1:45–2:55 AM	70 min
Halt 7:43–8:37 PM	54 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (8:56 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:54 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

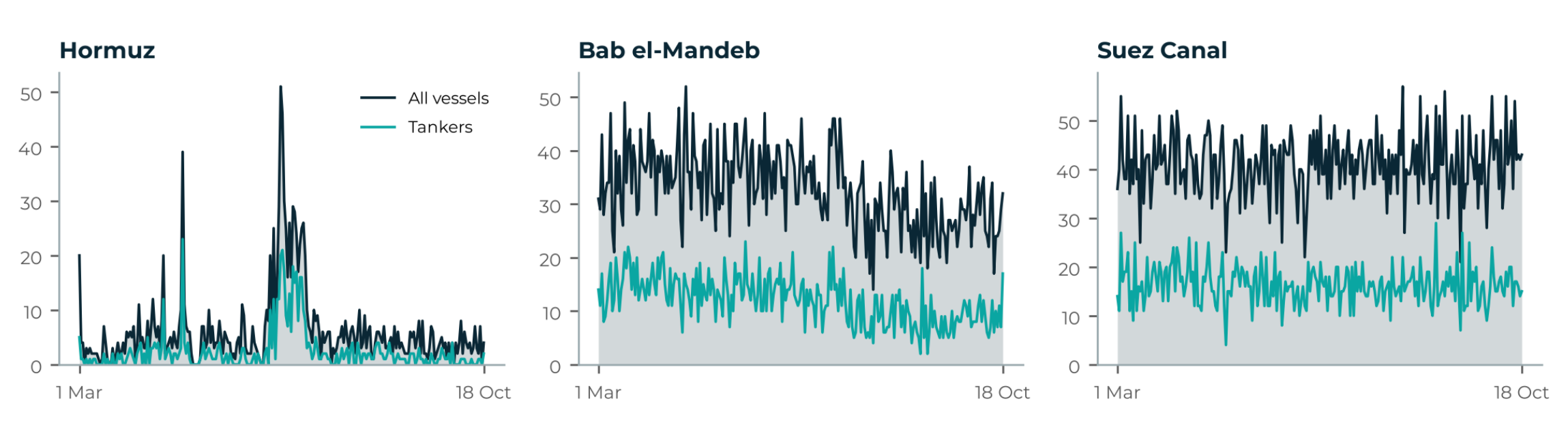
6

ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

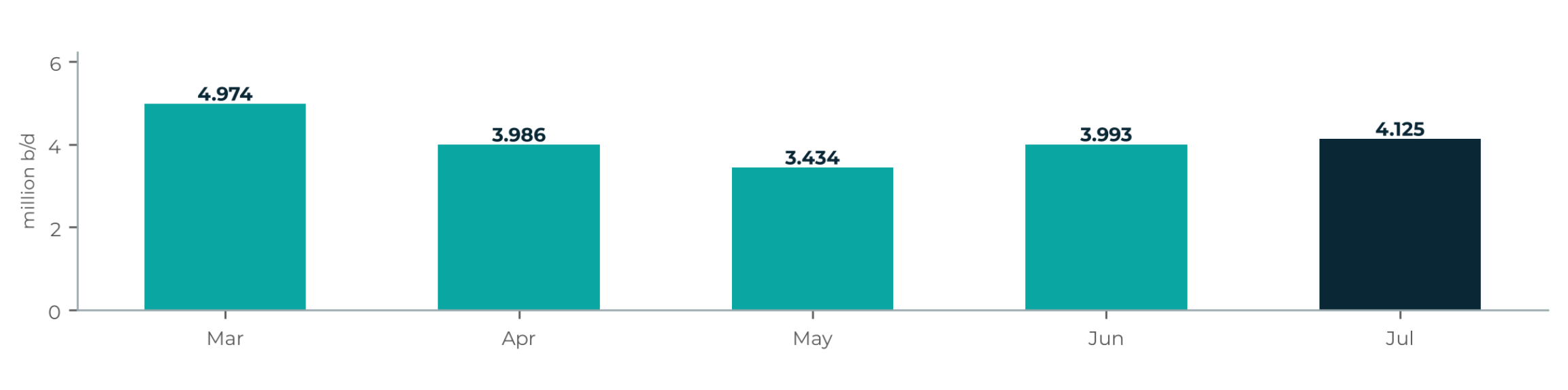
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 8:57 AM, Wed 21 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

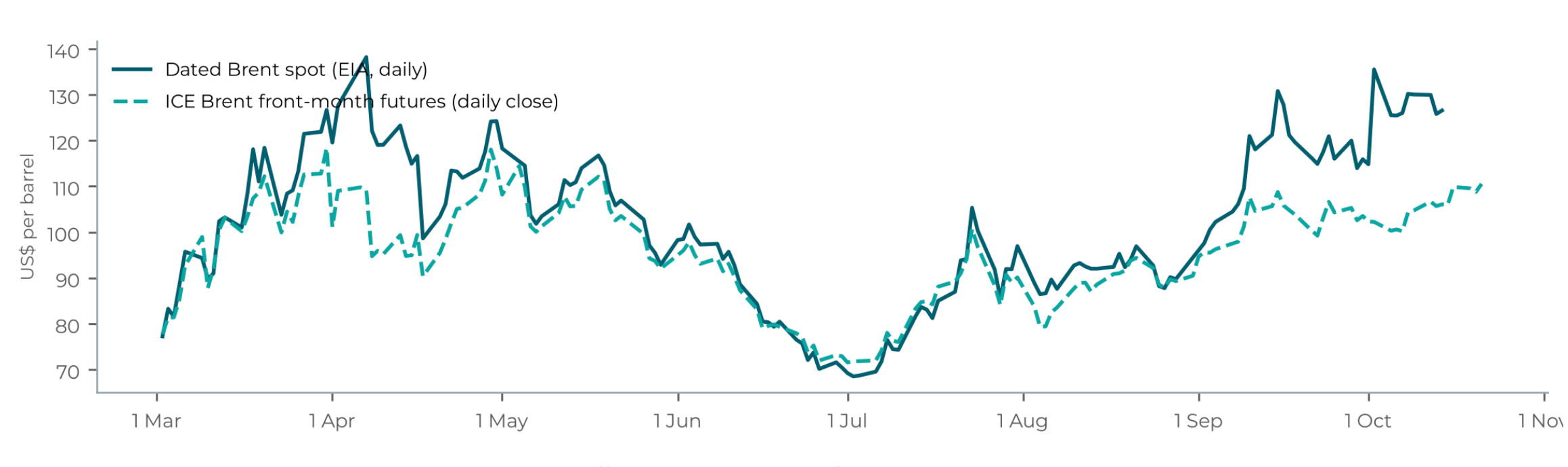


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$110.53	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 8:46 AM, Wed 21 Oct AST (+1.6% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

7

METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 8:57 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
8:57 AM, Wed 21 Oct	8:57 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	12:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 12:00 PM